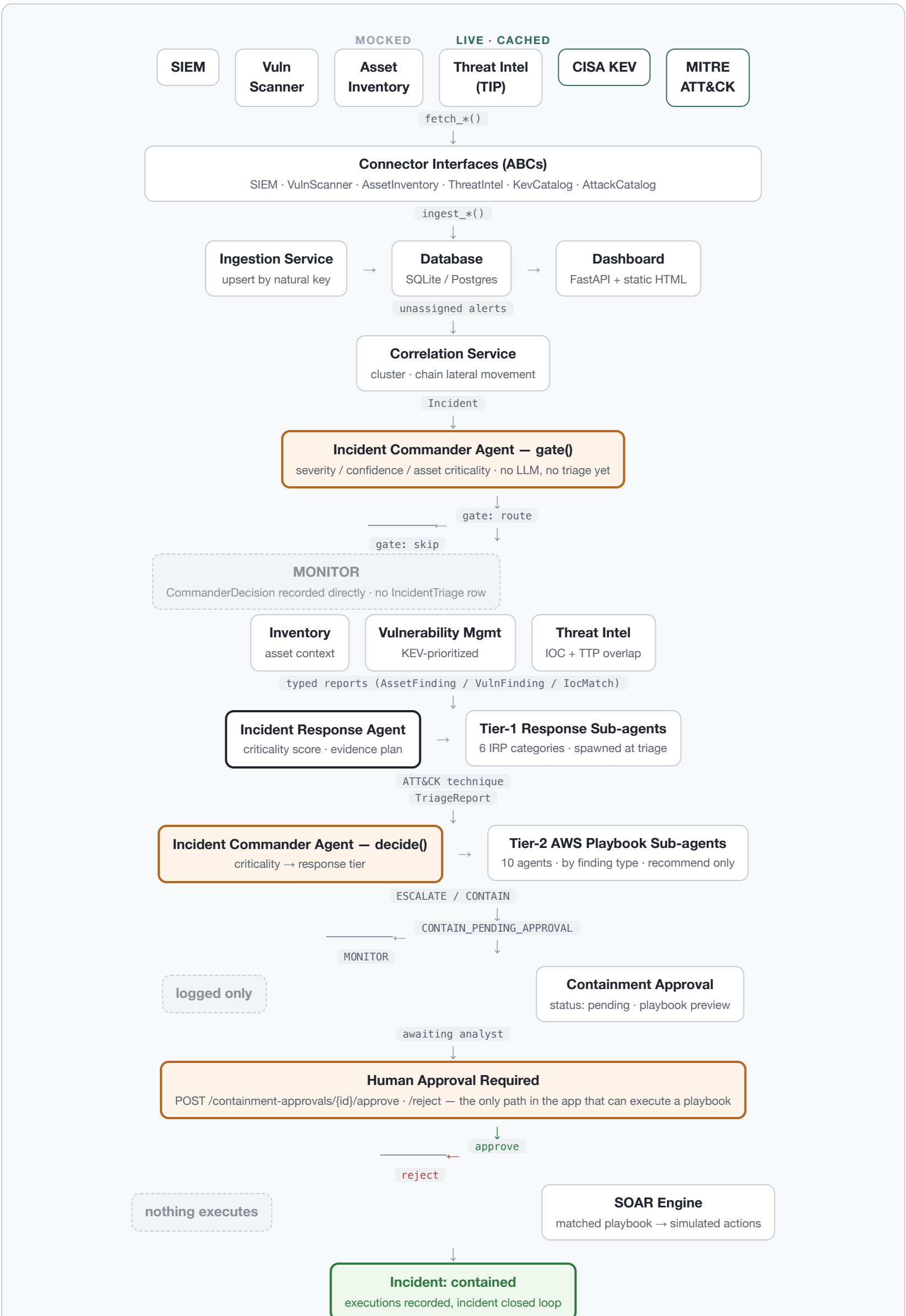


vbg_defense_orchestrator — pipeline map

How a raw feed becomes a triaged incident — and the two moments the Incident Commander gets a say: a cheap gate before triage even starts, and the final response-tier call after it. The one gate no automated path is allowed to skip is still the human approval below.



The Commander now bookends the pipeline: **gate()** screens every correlated incident on cheap signals alone (severity, confidence, one Inventory Agent lookup) before any expensive work runs — vuln/threat-intel lookups, evidence planning, sub-agent dispatch, LLM rationale all stay behind it. Everything below **Human Approval Required** is still the one gate no automated path can skip: **reject** records the decision and stops, or **approve** hands the incident to the SOAR Engine — the only code path in the app that can execute a SOAR playbook.

- ☒ Incident Commander (gate / decide)
- ☒ hub agent (thick border)
- ☐ terminal — nothing executes
- ☒ terminal — remediation applied

THE GATE IS NEW
`IncidentCommanderAgent.gate()` runs before the IR Agent ever sees the incident. It only reads `Incident.severity / confidence` and one cheap Inventory Agent lookup — no vuln scan, no threat intel, no LLM call. Incidents that don't clear it get a direct **MONITOR** via `skip()`, with no `IncidentTriage` row at all.

TWO DISPATCH TIERS, TWO TRIGGERS
Tier-1 spawns off the IR Agent at triage, keyed by ATT&CK technique ID. Tier-2 spawns off the Commander's `decide()` call, keyed by GuardDuty/CloudTrail finding type. Both only ever recommend.

THE APPROVAL GATE IS ABSOLUTE
`approval_service.approve_containment()` is the sole caller of `soar_engine.evaluate_and_execute()`. There is no criticality score, however high, that skips it.